

Build a clear prompt

Activity · Prompting techniques · ~15 min

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You're signed in to the FASTR platform with the AI Assistant available
- ☐ You have a real workshop task in mind that you'd normally do (a chart, a summary, a slide for a meeting)

WHY IT MATTERS

A clear prompt produces a useful answer; a vague prompt produces a generic one. The difference is **what you put in** — most of the value comes from a 30-second pre-flight before you type.

Four questions before you type

Pick a task you do regularly. Before writing the prompt, answer these four questions:

Question	Your answer
1. What do I need? A chart? A summary? A slide for a meeting?	
2. Who is it for? My director? A donor? My country team?	
3. What should it cover? Which indicators? Which regions? What time period?	
4. What does a good result look like? Would I recognise it if the AI got it wrong?	

Now write your prompt

Use your answers above to write a prompt that names **what**, **who**, **scope**, and **success criterion**. One paragraph is fine.

Your prompt: _____

Tips

Refining is normal. You don't have to get the prompt right in one go — you can keep talking to the AI to narrow it down. The four questions above just give you a stronger first message.

What's next

Move on to **Explore with the AI Assistant** to try this prompt against the platform and learn how small changes to a prompt change the output.